

Exam, 42620, part 2/2: **POLICY BRIEF**

This is a written assignment submitted in groups with individual attribution of responsibility. The assignment is written as a **policy brief**, which is a short report for a non-specialized audience.

SCENARIO

Assume the following scenario. The Danish energy islands on Bornholm and in the North Sea are being planned. You work as sustainability experts for a relevant decision maker.

You have developed a plan for how to improve the sustainability of the energy islands, and the decision maker has already decided to implement it.

However, the decision maker knows that the energy islands are contested. They are concerned that your plans for improving sustainability will not sufficiently take the perspectives of diverse stakeholders into account and are therefore likely to meet public resistance.

Consequently, they have asked you to **map the controversy over the energy islands and recommend a strategy for responsible implementation of your plans based on that analysis.**

They want you to write a policy brief where you explain your methodology, present your analysis, and provide your recommendations.

Before you write the brief, *you must decide what your plans for improved sustainability look like.* You can take inspiration from the proposal you developed on Part 1 of the course as part of your Assignment B.

Before you write the brief, *you must also choose which decision maker you are working for.* It must be an organization with relevant decision competence in relation to the implementation of your plans for improved sustainability. It could be the Danish Ministry of Climate, Energy and Utilities, the Municipality of Bornholm, Energinet Danmark, or some other organization depending on what your plans are.

REQUIREMENTS

The policy brief should contain four parts, namely **introduction, methodology, analysis** and **recommendations**.

The policy brief must be **written and submitted in groups**.

To facilitate individual grading, **you must clearly mark who has written which parts of the text.** This is done on the front page using the associated template and by adding your name directly under the headline of the parts you have written in the relevant parts of the text. **NB: PARTS OF THE TEXT THAT ARE NOT CLEARLY ATTRIBUTED TO A SINGLE STUDENT CANNOT COUNT IN THE EVALUATION.** The only part where you can attribute shared responsibility is the introduction.

Each group member must write **two sections** and contribute to the shared introduction. One of the sections must be written for the **analysis** part of the policy brief, the other section must be written either for the **methodology or the recommendations** part.

The **length** of each part is specified below in number of characters. Besides paragraph text and headlines, character limits **include** white space, footnotes, captions, quotes and citations in the text. Character limits **exclude** the bibliography (list of references), text that is part of figures, and template front page. Note the character limit for the introduction is in total, whereas the limits for methodology, analysis and recommendations are per student. Character limits are +/- 10%.

Deadline on the last day of the course at 17:00 where you must submit on Learn.

Part	Specifications	Length
Introduction Goal: Summarize findings and recommendations.	Short presentation of your plans for improved sustainability of the energy islands. You are the sustainability experts in this scenario. The assignment assumes that the plans are already approved. You should not argue for them, just present them as relevant context for the reader. Short presentation of your chosen decision maker. Make it clear who the policy brief is for and why. Short statement on how you have chosen to map the controversy. The Danish energy islands are publicly debated in many different contexts and in relation to different issues. Make it clear how you have chosen your focus, considering who the policy brief is for and why you have been tasked with preparing it. Short summary of the findings from your analysis and your recommendations. <i>You must assign collective responsibility for this part.</i>	2000 characters in total
Methodology Goal: Explain how you have analysed the data in the issue atlas on the Danish energy islands and why.	Explain how you have searched the dataset from the issue atlas of the Danish Energy Islands to find the actor statements you will be analysing. Justify why this search strategy addresses the focus of your policy brief (considering the nature of your proposal for improved sustainability and your chosen decision maker). Present the data visualizations you will be using in the analysis and explain how they were made, how they should be read and how they helped you select actor statements. Explain how your methodology follows principles for controversy mapping using methodological concepts from part 2 of the course. All your data visualizations should be presented in this part and can then be referred to in the analysis. All data visualizations should be annotated. Limit the number of data visualizations you include to the number of students in the group and preferably less. Each section of the methodology should cover part of the above, each student must use a methodological concept from Part 2 of the course in their section. <i>Half of the group members must be responsible for a section in this part. For groups of 5, it is either 3 sections for this part and 2 sections for the recommendations part, or vice versa.</i>	2000 characters per student
Analysis Goal: Map who the actors are and what	Provide a qualitative analysis of selected actor statements. Use analytical concepts from Part 2 of the course to do so. The analysis should help us understand how different (types of) actors understand the issues in the energy island	2500 characters

they are concerned about.	controversy differently, how different issues concern different actors, on different media channels, at different points in time. Refer to the data visualizations from the methodology to support your analysis and make data-driven arguments following the principles from Part 2 of the course. The analysis part, as a whole, should cover a variety of analytical concepts from Part 2 of the course but each student should choose ONE analytical focus in their section, for example, ethics, markets, or risk. You must cite the actor statements you use to support your findings. You can cite them simply with their ID number from the issue atlas. <i>Each group member must be responsible for a section in this part.</i>	per student
Recommendations Goal: Develop an RRI strategy that is supported by the findings from your analysis.	Based on your findings from the analysis, you must recommend a strategy for responsible development and implementation of your suggested sustainability improvements using RRI principles. Present your recommendations and explain how they are supported by findings. Each student should choose ONE interventional concept from Part 2 of the course to justify parts of the recommendations and discuss how it supports RRI. <i>Half of the group members must be responsible for a section in this part. For groups of 5, it is either 3 sections for the methods part and 2 sections for this part, or vice versa. Adjust the relative size of the parts according to your choice.</i>	2000 characters per student

We use the following **evaluation criteria** for individual grading. Each approved evaluation criteria counts for 1 point. The maximum score for the Policy Brief is therefore 5 out of 5 points.

	Approved	Not approved
Introduction	It is clear who the policy brief is for and why. It is clear what the plans are for improved sustainability and how they motivate the chosen methodology. Findings from analysis and recommended strategy for responsible implementation are concisely summarized.	Proposed sustainability improvements, main findings from analysis, or recommended strategy for responsible implementation are not summarized.
Use of theory in the analysis part	The chosen analytical concept is explained correctly and used in a relevant context. The student's section contributes to a good conceptual variety in the analysis part with its own distinct contribution.	The chosen concept is not adequately explained or not used in a relevant context.
Use of data in the analysis part	Actor statements from the Issue atlas are qualitatively analysed and properly cited. It is clear how data visualizations from the methodology part are used. It is clear how both actor statements and visualizations support the findings.	Actor statements are not qualitatively analysed or properly cited. It is not clear how data visualizations are used. Findings are unclear and not supported by analysis.
Clarity of the methodology OR recommendations part	METHODOLOGY has a clear focus. Explains how actor statements were found, how visualizations were made, and how they should be read. RECOMMENDATIONS are clear, explicitly motivated by findings from the analysis, and part of a coherent strategy.	EITHER: Methodology does not adequately explain how visualizations were made and actor statements found. OR: Recommendation is unclear and not motivated by findings from the analysis.
Use of theory from Part 2 of the course in the methodology OR recommendations part	METHODOLOGY: The chosen methodological concept is explained correctly and used in a relevant context. RECOMMENDATIONS: The chosen interventional concept is explained correctly and used in a relevant context.	The chosen concept is not adequately explained or not used in a relevant context.

PASS/FAIL THRESHOLDS

The two components of the exam (the Multiple-Choice Test and this Policy Brief) each count for 50%. We attribute a maximum of 5 points for each (max 10 points in total) and you need 8 out of 10 points to pass the course.

This means that you can pass with 3 out of 5 points on the Policy Brief if you get 5 out of 5 points on the MCT, or vice versa.